PLUG AND PLAY · PAID MEDIA · OCTOBER 2026

Paid media audit and new structure

Meta and Google Search: what works, what doesn't, and how we rebuild for post-Andromeda Meta

$180,940
Meta

$89,478
Google Search

1 Jan – 13 Oct 2026
spend covered

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SUMMARY

The short version

Working

- **Report ads with a data hook** (robotics, quantum, energy grid, AI trends): $4–$8 per lead.
- **Broad audiences in Europe and the Middle East**: $7.42 per lead in the last 30 days, about half the US.
- **Google: one campaign per region** instead of per state, and corporate searches with a matching page.

Not working

- **Meta is built for the old algorithm**: 30 ad sets on $160 a day, about 4 leads per ad set a week. Meta needs about 50 to learn.
- **Splitting by country didn't make us local**: the country ad sets ran the same English ads, at $33.07 per lead ($71,634).
- **Google**: 60% of spend lands on the homepage, which has no form, and 37% pays for our own name.

What we change

- **Meta**: 3 campaigns, 5 ad sets, 8–15 creatives each in local languages; students and job seekers stop counting as results.
- **Google**: brand apart, corporate ad groups from new keyword research, a form behind every ad.
- **Pages and tests**: one corporate landing page, and a 90-day plan that tests new formats every two weeks.

Meta campaigns	Meta ad sets	Leads per ad set a week	Google clicks to the homepage	Google spend on our own name, mixed in
~~9~~ → 3	~~30~~ → 5	~~≈4~~ → ≈29-52	~~60%~~ → 0%	~~37%~~ → 0%

META · ANDROMEDA

Meta changed how it picks who sees our ads. Our set-up didn't.

Our set-up today

US-California · US East Coast · US & Canada · US Middle-South

EMEA · Middle East · Western Europe

7 location campaigns × the same 5 topic ad sets · $10–$26 a day per campaign · about $4 a day per ad set

- Split by location, job title and interest, with mostly the same English ads in each
- The US & Canada campaign overlaps the three US-state campaigns
- About 8 ads per ad set, many of them copies of each other

30	≈$4	≈8
ad sets	a day per ad set	ads per ad set, many copies

≈4 leads per ad set a week

What Meta rewards now

1 prospecting campaign

Europe & Middle East · broad

US & Canada · broad

- Few campaigns, 1–3 broad ad sets: location, language, age and exclusions are the only hard limits
- 8–20 really different creatives per ad set, each one speaking to one persona: the creative picks the people

2	≈$55	8–15
broad ad sets	a day per ad set	different concepts each

≈50 leads per ad set a week to learn

Andromeda is the system Meta has used since December 2024 to match ads to people. It reads the creative itself to decide who sees it; audience settings are only suggestions. Many small ad sets with small budgets each get too little data to learn.

Our own data: grouping beats splitting, 2.6× cheaper per lead

Split: one ad set per country, job-title audiences

EMEA prospecting Feb-Jul → 1 ad set per country + 7 US states → Report and platform ads → Report pages

COUNTRY AD SETS · COST PER LEAD

UK	France	Italy	Saudi Arabia
$23.00	$36.50	$35.01	$32.07

+ 7 US-STATE AD SETS IN THIS EMEA CAMPAIGN · $28,879 (40%) SPENT

New Jersey	New York	Texas	Florida	Washington DC
$5,097	$4,627	$4,539	$4,276	$3,581

Indiana	Arizona
$3,523	$3,236

Job titles by country (CEO, CTO, CIO, CSO, MD, Head of IT…), age 25+, past leads excluded

$71,634	2,166	$33.07
spent	leads	per lead

Grouped: 19 countries together, one ad set per report topic

EMEA prospecting test Jan-Jul → 1 ad set per report topic → Report ads with a data hook → Report pages

BIGGEST AD SETS · COST PER LEAD

Decarbonisation	Spain energy grid	Quantum	AI & robotics
$8.14	$8.76	$10.47	$11.07

Job titles only
$50.09

Tech and C-level leaders with interests that match each report, 19 countries, age 25+

$18,001	1,437	$12.53
spent	leads	per lead

Without its US states, the split campaign still cost **$30.20 per lead** in the UK, France, Italy and Saudi Arabia, which the grouped campaign also covered. **The report topic did the targeting better than country and job-title splits.**

Going local is right. The country split didn't make our ads local.

What the country ad sets ran

1 EMEA campaign → 4 country ad sets: UK, FR, IT, SA → EN the same ads → EN the same pages

THE SAME ENGLISH AD · COST PER LEAD

	Grouped	UK	France / Italy
Quantum video	$7.47	$20.38	France $36.22
Spain grid ad	$7.67	$18.02	Italy $29.08

OUR ADS BY LANGUAGE

English	French, Italian, German, Arabic, Portuguese	Spanish
~240 live	about 3 in all	0

2.4–4.8× the cost per lead of the same English ad in a country ad set

Local, the Andromeda way

1 prospecting campaign → 1 broad ad set per region → 5 language versions in every ad → page in the ad's language

One ad
a version per language →

- FR French speakers
- DE German speakers
- IT Italian speakers
- ES Spanish speakers
- EN everyone else

Meta shows each person the version in their language

- **Hard limits:** countries, languages, age 25+, no past leads
- **The creative targets:** language, persona, local topic and local proof (partners, cases, office events)
- **Own ad set for a market** only when its budget buys about 50 leads a week ($53 a day at Europe's cost per lead)

Local content beats generic 3:1 on cost per lead (EMEA, H1 2026). For that, the ad and the page have to be local, not just the audience.

What's working on Meta

Broad prospecting · Europe & Middle East

Live

3 campaigns $41 a day → 12 topic ad sets → ≈8 ads each → Report pages

$1,394	188	$7.42
spent, 30 days	leads, 30 days	per lead

Broad (Advantage+) in 19–20 countries of Europe and the Gulf; past leads excluded

WHY IT WORKS

- Cheap reach: $8–$13 per 1,000 views, against $33–$44 in the US
- Deep Tech report ads: $4–$5 per lead here

IMPROVE

- One broad ad set instead of 3 campaigns and 12 ad sets
- More creative variety instead of copies

Report-topic ad sets · 19 countries

Ended Jul

1 campaign $50 a day → 1 ad set per report topic → Report ads → Report pages

$18,001	1,437	$12.53
spent, Jan–Jul	leads	per lead

Tech and C-level leaders with interests that match each report

WHY IT WORKS

- Each ad set paired one report with the people who care about it
- Quantum, Spain energy grid and decarbonisation reports: $8–$10 per lead

IMPROVE

- Bring these reports back as creatives in one broad ad set

Retargeting · worldwide

Live

1 campaign $41 a day → 1 ad set → 53 ads → Innovation platform page

$1,405	108	$13.01
spent, 30 days	registrations	per lead

People who sent us a form in the last 180 days (Meta may widen it)

WHY IT WORKS

- Warm audience that already knows us
- Proof from the press: best ad “Fast-Track Corporate Innovation”, $15.66 per lead this year

IMPROVE

- Audience under 1,000 people seeing ads 5.75 times: $20 a day and 4–6 ads, refreshed every 2–4 weeks

What's not working on Meta, and what replaces it

NOT WORKING	INSTEAD
The US split into 4 campaigns and 16 ad sets $72 a day in total; $13.26 per lead in the last 30 days, about twice Europe	**One US & Canada ad set** Broad, $55 a day, with the report creatives that work in Europe
Brand and Health ad sets Brand in California $139.57 for 1 lead; Health in the US $36–$51 per lead	**Proof and health as creatives, not ad sets** Press quotes, case results and health reports, tried first in the test campaign
Job-title ad sets Innovation Leader job titles $50.09 per lead; country job-title ad sets $23–$37	**The ad names the buyer** Broad audience; the creative says who it is for, e.g. innovation leaders at large companies
Traffic campaigns FR_Alibaba took 41% of the last 30 days' spend for $0.03 clicks outside our markets; US clicks go to a page with no form	**Lead campaigns only** Traffic money moves to prospecting
Ads that don't deliver still run Healthcare voice-memo video: 3 leads for $174. 2025 report ad: 0 leads after $373	**Pause now, then a weekly rule** After $50 spent, pause any ad 20% above the average cost per lead

META · CREATIVES

Which creatives bring leads, and what we make next

BEST ADS THIS YEAR · COST PER LEAD

Quantum report static	$6.86	126 leads
Quantum report short video	$7.47	188 leads
AI trend report report ad	$7.48	56 leads
Spain energy grid carousel	$7.67	207 leads
AI & robotics report product video, Europe	$4.10	73 leads
Press quote retargeting image	$15.66	165 leads

BY FORMAT · Q1 2026 · COST PER LEAD

Static	Carousel	Short video
$12.91	$13.77	$20.54

$9.23 video showing the product

$20.79 video of a person talking

STOP

- Event and case-study videos and ebooks in narrow ad sets: $129–$190 per lead
- One quantum video copied into 12+ separate ads: it splits the learning

WHAT WE MAKE NEXT · 8–15 CONCEPTS PER AD SET

×3 Data-hook static	×2 Report carousel	×2 Product explainer
×2 Case result or logos	test Talking head	FR · DE · IT · ES version of each

EACH CONCEPT SPEAKS TO ONE PERSONA

Innovation & R&D leaders · C-level · Digital leaders (CDO) · Governments

REFRESH

- New ideas start in the test campaign: 2–5 ads each, 7 days
- New concepts every 2–3 weeks; winners stay, losers go

META · NEW STRUCTURE

New Meta structure: 3 campaigns, 5 ad sets, the creative does the targeting

Goal: a lead form sent, with student and job-seeker answers left out (corporate and government only once there is volume). Every ad set: location, language, age 25+, exclusions, ICP job titles as suggestions.

CAMPAIGNS	AD SETS · WHO	CREATIVES · WHAT THEY SEE	LANDING PAGE
Prospecting CBO · $110 a day	**Europe & Middle East** Broad · ≈$55 a day	Data hook ×3 · Carousel ×2 · Product video ×2 · Proof ×2 · Talking head ×1 Every ad in EN FR DE IT ES	**Report pages** in the ad's language
	US & Canada Broad · ≈$55 a day	The same 8-15 concepts	
Retargeting $20 a day	**Visitors and past leads** Last 180 days	Press quote · Case result · Partner logos · Talk to us	**Corporate page**
Creative test ABO · $30 a day (20%)	**2 test ad sets** $15 a day each	New idea A 2-5 · New idea B 2-5	Winners move to Prospecting after 7 days

Campaigns	Ad sets	Budget per prospecting ad set	Leads per ad set a week	Total budget
~~9~~ → 3	~~30~~ → 5	~~$4~~ → $55 a day	~~≈4~~ → ≈29-52	$160 a day, same

How broad still gets us our ICP

CONTROL	TODAY	NEW
1 Who can see the ad	Countries and age; CRM exclusion lists may not apply (custom-audience terms not accepted)	Countries, language, age 25+; customers, current leads, students and job seekers excluded
2 Where Meta looks first	Job titles and interests as suggestions (Advantage+ audience on), split across 30 small ad sets	The same ICP job titles and people like our corporate leads (lookalike) as suggestions, in one broad ad set
3 What the ad says	Most-used headlines say what, not who it's for: “Access World-Class Startups”, “Join the Innovation Platform”	Every ad names the buyer: innovation, R&D and digital leaders at 10,000+ companies, or governments
4 What counts as a result	Any form sent on a welcome page, students and job seekers included	Now: students and job seekers stop counting. Next, as volume allows: corporate and government only, then CRM-qualified leads
5 How we judge each ad	Ranked by cost per lead	Every Monday: each ad's share of leads that fit the ICP (the ad name is in every lead's UTM); cut ads whose cheap leads don't

Meta can't target company size or a list of companies. It finds more people like the ones who trigger the result, so **what we count as a result is our sharpest targeting**.

Google Search: what works and what doesn't

ONE CAMPAIGN PER US STATE OR AREA (JAN-MAY) VS ONE PER REGION (AUG-OCT) · COST PER CONVERSION

New York	US East Coast	Florida	Texas	Arizona	New Jersey	→	US & Canada	Europe & Middle East
$614	$366	$322	$313	$284	$279		$49	$46

GOOGLE TODAY · LIVE CAMPAIGNS · % OF NORTH AMERICA AND EUROPE & MIDDLE EAST SPEND SINCE 10 AUG

3 campaigns
- North America
- Europe & Middle East
- Coworking, Silicon Valley

→ **9** ad groups: the same 4 in each region, plus coworking
- Brand 37%
- Startup collaboration 42%
- Innovation 14%
- AI strategy 7%

→ **9** ads: 1 per ad group

→ **3** main landing pages
- Homepage 60%
- Innovation platform 28%
- Supply-chain page 3%

Working

- **Corporate searches + a matching page**: the Innovation ad group sends supply-chain searches to the supply-chain page. 24% of clicks convert, $12.86 each.
- **Corporate ad copy**: “Top Corporate Accelerator | Corporate Innovation Lab” converted 9–10% of clicks at $33–$40, half the cost of the generic ad.
- **Best markets now**: Saudi Arabia $36, Qatar $50, France $59, UK $60 per conversion.

Not working

- **The homepage has no lead form**, only a newsletter sign-up.
- **Our own name** (“plug and play” searches) sits inside campaigns that run out of budget.
- **Startup-side ad groups**: “Venture Capitalist” headline, coworking extras, “startup india certificate”.
- **Google picks the searches** (broad match + AI Max) on $34-$37 a day; budgets cut 71–76% in three days; business name, logo and 14 of 18 images disapproved.

GOOGLE SEARCH · NEW STRUCTURE

New Google structure: brand apart, corporate themes, a form behind every ad

Step 1 · Keyword research in Semrush
Corporate themes, search volume and cost per click for the US, UK, France, Germany, Spain and Italy; competitor terms; negatives.

CAMPAIGNS	AD GROUPS · THEMES	ADS · 2 EACH	LANDING PAGE
Brand All markets · capped budget	"plug and play" searches, exact and phrase	Ad A · Ad B	Corporate page
Corporate · US & Canada Phrase and exact	Corporate innovation · Startup scouting · Open innovation & pilots · Industry: supply chain, health, energy	Ad A · Ad B	Matching page with a form
Corporate · Europe & Middle East Phrase and exact	Corporate innovation · Startup scouting · Open innovation & pilots · Industry: supply chain, health, energy	Ad A · Ad B	Matching page with a form

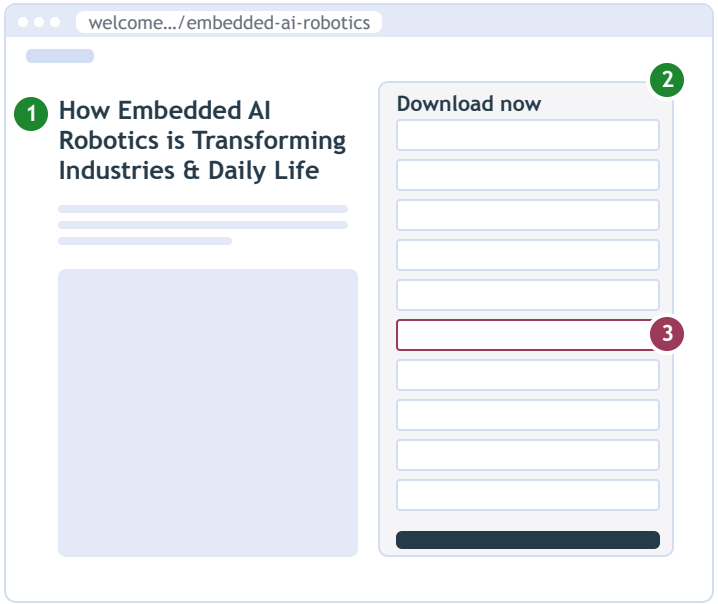
Rules: standing negatives (jobs, careers, apply, funding for my startup, pitch, grants, education, free) · location "presence" · goal: corporate form (downloads count as secondary) · AI Max later, as a test.

Brand spend inside non-brand	Startup-side ad groups	Clicks to the homepage	Broad-match keywords	Total budget
~~37%~~ → 0%	~~42%~~ → 0%	~~60%~~ → 0%	~~all~~ → none	$76 a day, same

Our landing pages today

Report page

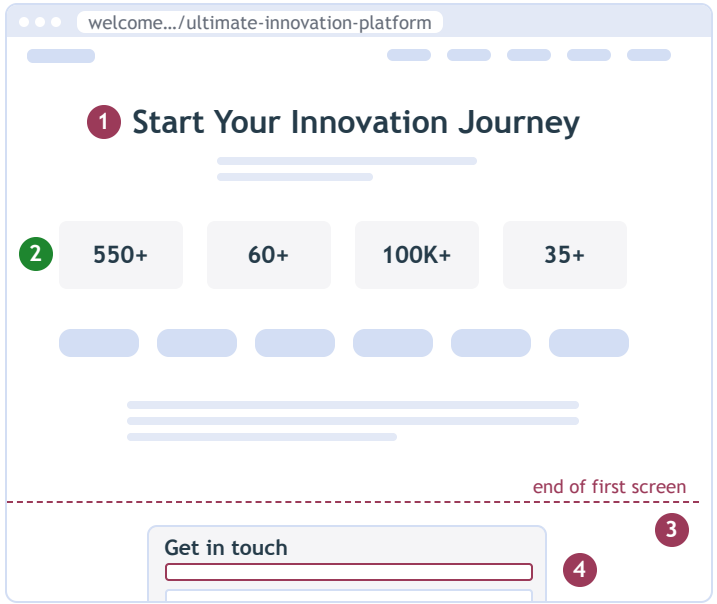
Meta · works



1. One topic, clear headline
2. Form next to the headline; asks company size and job level
3. “Student” and “looking for a job” can submit, and count as leads

Innovation platform page

Google + retargeting



1. One message for corporates, startups, governments and investors
2. Strong stats: 550+ partners, 60+ locations
3. Form below the first screen; on phone, 2 screens down
4. Profile dropdown first; corporate path has 12 fields and no company size

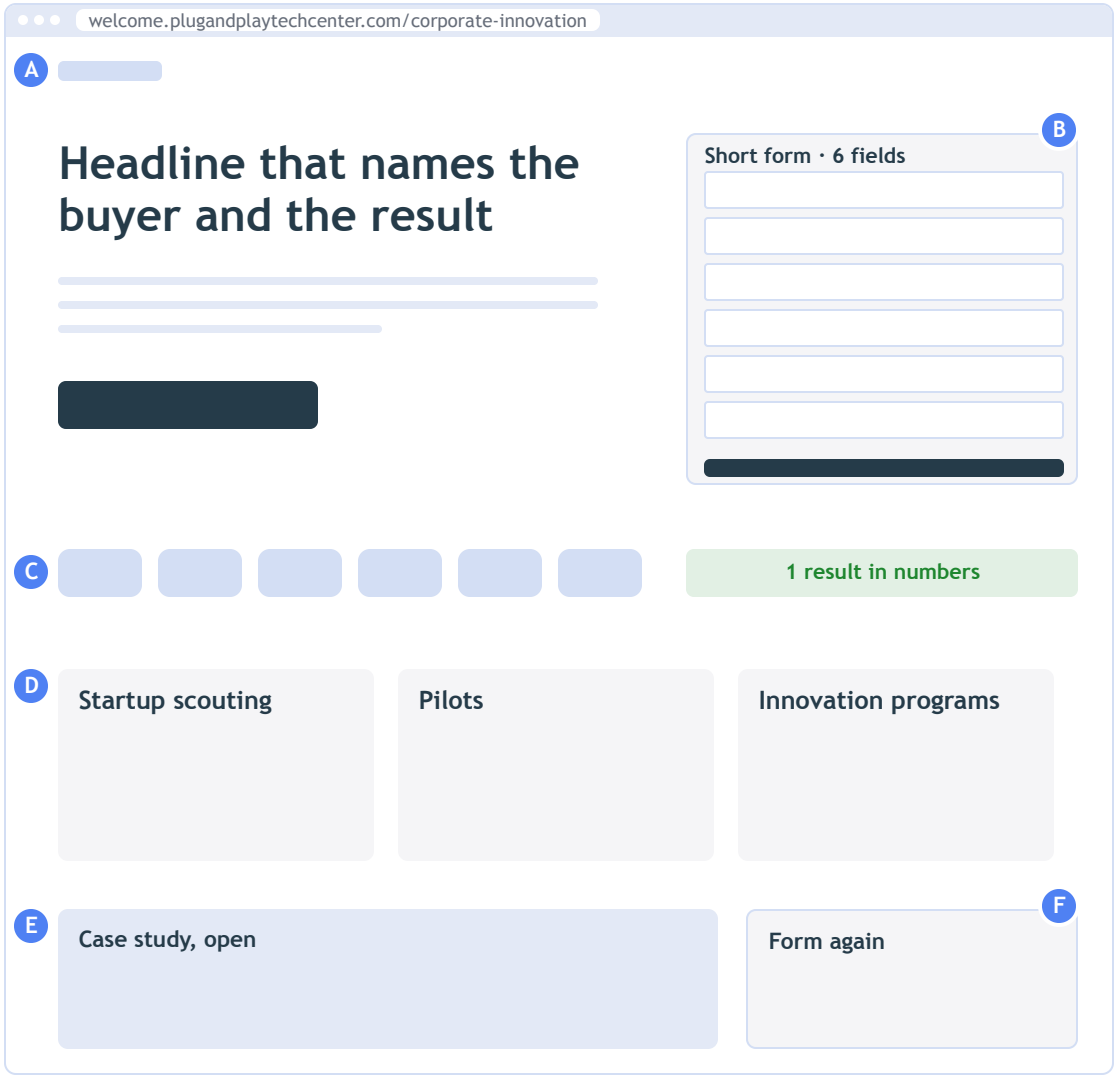
Homepage

60% of Google spend



1. Message for everyone
2. No lead form: only a newsletter sign-up at the bottom
3. On phone, two chat pop-ups cover the headline
4. 156 links to leave the page

The corporate landing page we propose



ON PHONE



Form within the first screen

- **A** **No main menu:** one page, one goal. Startups get their own page
- **B** **Short form at the top:** name, work email, company, company size, role, country. No student or job-seeker option
- **C** **Proof next to the form:** partner logos and one result in numbers
- **D** **Three things we do:** startup scouting, pilots, innovation programs
- **E** **A case study, open**, not behind a form
- **F** **The form again** at the end

BEFORE AND AFTER · INNOVATION PLATFORM PAGE

Fields on the corporate form	~~12~~ → 6
Company size asked	~~no~~ → yes
Student option	~~yes~~ → no
Form on phone	~~2 screens down~~ → first screen

SAME TEMPLATE FOR

Corporate innovation · Startup scouting · Each Google theme

PLAN

90-day plan: build, learn, test, scale

Days 1-7
BUILD

Meta
New 3-campaign structure with the proven ads; pause old campaigns, traffic and losing ads

Meta Google
Students and job seekers stop counting as results

Google
Brand campaign apart, negatives, no startup or coworking extras, no homepage traffic

Google
Semrush keyword research: US, UK, FR, DE, ES, IT

Pages
Paid forms: drop student and job-seeker options; add company size

Days 8-30
LEARN

Meta
No changes for 7 days, then budget moves of 20% at most

Meta
FR, DE, IT and ES versions of the best 3-4 ads, inside the same ads

Meta
Test 1: the same report as static, carousel and video

Google
Corporate ad groups from the research; weekly search-term review

Pages
Build the corporate landing page

Data
Weekly: ICP share of each ad's leads

Days 31-60
TEST

Meta
Test 2: talking head vs proof (case results, logos)

Meta
Test 3: local topic and proof per market (partners, cases, events) vs global

Pages
Local-language versions of the best report page

Google
AI Max test once there are 30+ qualified conversions a month

Data
Send qualified leads from the CRM to Meta and Google

Days 61-90
SCALE

Meta Google
Scale the winners in 20% steps; new creatives every 2-3 weeks

Meta Google
Bid on qualified leads, not form fills

Pages
Test an interactive assessment instead of a PDF

Plan
2027 plan built on the results

TO START, WE NEED

1. **A yes to the new Meta and Google structures**, same total budget.
2. **US budget**: the US ad set needs about $95 a day to learn ($53 in Europe); the plan gives it $55.
3. **Web team time** in weeks 2-4 for the corporate landing page.
4. **Local teams** to write or check the French, German, Italian and Spanish versions.